

LOVE IN THE
LAP OF LUXURY:
Ranbir and
Bipasha



film review Glam Nirvana

BACHNA AE HASEENO

Director: Siddharth Anand

Starring: Ranbir Kapoor,
Bipasha Basu

Ladkiyan shikar hoti hain, yaar nahin (girls are to be hunted, not befriended), says the particularly noxious buddy to the hero. He, having kissed and told with one girl and dumped another at the altar, laughs boyishly but by then love has struck. Mr Goodbody has found his Ms Hotbod. And what was till then a dude movie, suddenly turns into a chick flick, with every convention of that genre being duly honoured. But that's not the reason *Bachna Ae Haseeno* is Glamour Nirvana. This is consumerist Bollywood at its best. Bipasha Basu—is there a woman in Bollywood more scrumptiously sultry than she?—demands Evian, not gutter ka pani; fires a hapless assistant for not securing an instant

reservation at Wasabi on a Saturday night; and shops only at Dolce & Gabbana. She, dressed by Aki Narula, in full on bitch goddess mode, sets the tone of the film. Unashamedly luxe, gorging on the scenery (the screenplay moves effortlessly, if needlessly, from Switzerland to Australia), and happily derivative (a character in the movie has watched *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* 17 times), the film marks the relaunch of Ranbir Kapoor, after the unfortunate *Saawariya*. All plucked eyebrows, lean chest and pink shirts, Kapoor is the new-age boy, happy to be as commodified as the girls. He flutters his eyelashes at the camera, gets thrown out of *gori* bedrooms in just his underpants and loves a woman only after he learns to be her friend (“I just hang-wang with her”). The friends-turned-lovers routine is familiar from the wildly successful *Jaane Tu... Ya Jaane Na* as well, so I am guessing we will be seeing a whole series of

romcoms along these lines. The spirit is International Punjabi, the writing is hip Hinglish (as befitting dialogue writer Anvita Dutt Gupta's ad background) and what begins as an ultra Iron Man film ends up as an ode to grrrl power. This is *pind da shera* (as home at the Golden Temple as at the Gold Coast) meeting Global Girl (who drives cabs at night and studies in business school by day), and living happily ever after. To show its broad inclusive heart, it even has a showpiece Sikh, played by Kunal Kapoor, all melting brown eyes and silent adoration, whom one of the girls ends up with. And just in case we have any doubt about the zeitgeist of the film, Kapoor's character is called Raj. Yes, the very same Raj of *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* whose diaspora hero spawned a whole new genre. Watch it. In the best Yash Chopra tradition, it's like spending two hours in a super luxury store sipping Veuve Clicquot. Not buying, just looking. **by Kaverie Bamzai**

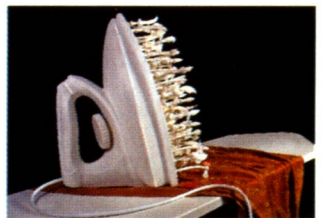
recommendations Art and Fancy



Oil on canvas by Rao

BANGALORE Gallery Sumukha will host an exhibition, Paintings and Installations, by artist Raghavendra Rao. He works with several media, though he is known for his paintings and sculptures. He explores an uncharted area where the memories of a city are steadily erased by development, to an extent “that one day even the monstrous structures created around us look beautiful”. From August 25 to September 10.

by Nirmala Ravindran



A work by Reena Kallat

MUMBAI A water tap drips a blooded red of a war-infested time, while we carry on with life unaffected. Subodh Gupta's installation is among the collection of incisive works in Bodhi Art Gallery's exhibition, Everywhere is War and Rumours of War. The collection features over 50 works in various media by many internationally known artists: Prasad Bhavan, Francesco Clemente, Anju Dodiya, Reena Kallat and many more. On display till September 27.

by Neha Thirani